

Qroo Paul's Spanish Master Course

Lesson 46 Summary

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Hey everybody, it's Paul. So in this new series, I'm going to be talking about one of the most misunderstood parts of Spanish—*the subjunctive*. I've done several videos on it already, and people have been asking for more, or wondering if I have a playlist they can go through. That's what led me to create this new series: **Spanish Subjunctive Triggers**.

In each episode, I'll show you specific grammatical patterns—what I call *triggers*—that always require the subjunctive. If you just learn these patterns, you'll always know when to use it, no overthinking required.

Now, I know the subjunctive confuses a lot of people, and part of the problem is how it's explained. You've probably heard something like: *The subjunctive is used to express uncertainty, subjectivity, doubt, or hypothetical situations*. And yeah, that's not wrong, but it's not helpful either.

Let's be real—most of us hear that and then start second-guessing every sentence. Like in this example:

“You have to wash the car before your dad arrives.”

The verb “arrives” is in the subjunctive: *llegue*.

But wait—why? Is there doubt he's arriving? Is he missing? Are we hoping he *might* show up someday? It doesn't seem to fit that big definition.

Or how about this one:

“I usually get up before the sun comes out.”

That sounds like a routine. And we all know the sun's going to come out. So why is it *salga* and not *sale*?

That's why I don't teach the subjunctive by focusing on vague definitions. Instead, I teach **patterns**. Because here's the truth: if you just learn which phrases trigger the subjunctive, you'll be able to use it correctly every time.

One of those triggers—and the one I focus on in this video—is:

👉 **“antes de que” + subjunctive**

It means *before something else happens*, and it always requires the subjunctive when there's a **subject change**.

Here are a few examples:

- **Antes de que empiece la película, tengo que comprar palomitas.**
(Before the movie starts, I have to buy popcorn.)
- **Antes de que cante el gallo, debemos levantarnos.**
(Before the rooster crows, we should get up.)
- **Antes de que lleguen los invitados, debemos preparar la cena.**
(Before the guests arrive, we should prepare dinner.)

Now, we can flip the sentence around and put *antes de que* in the middle:

- **Debo comprar palomitas antes de que empiece la película.**

Same rule applies—if there's a subject change, you use *antes de que* plus the subjunctive.

But if there's **no subject change**, you don't need *que* or the subjunctive. Just use *antes de* followed by an infinitive.

Examples:

- **Suelo leer antes de acostarme.**
(I usually read before going to bed.)
- **Quiero hacer una lista antes de irme de vacaciones.**
(I want to make a list before going on vacation.)

So here's the rule I want you to take away today:

- **Subject change?** → *antes de que* + subjunctive
- **No subject change?** → *antes de* + infinitive

That's it. If you focus on learning these triggers, you'll use the subjunctive correctly without stressing over abstract definitions.

Oh, and if you're still a little shaky on how to conjugate verbs in the present subjunctive, I've got a separate video for that. It's kind of dry, but it gets the job done—and you'll find the link in the description.

I'll be covering more triggers in upcoming episodes, one or two per video, so it's easy to follow. If you don't want to miss them, be sure to subscribe and hit the little bell so you'll know when something new drops.

See you in the next one.

Hasta luego.